

2015 AP[®] Comparative Government and Politics Exam

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COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Section I

Time—45 minutes

55 Questions

Directions: Each of the questions or incomplete statements below is followed by five suggested answers or completions. Select the one that is best in each case and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

1. An electoral system based on proportional representation is more likely than a system based on single member districts to encourage
 - (A) gridlock between the executive and legislative branches of government
 - (B) split-ticket voting
 - (C) weaker legislative representation of minority groups
 - (D) the development of a political system dominated by the executive branch
 - (E) the development of a multiparty system
2. Coalition government is likelier to occur in
 - (A) federal systems of government
 - (B) constitutional monarchies
 - (C) parliamentary democracies with proportional representation electoral systems
 - (D) presidential democracies characterized by social homogeneity
 - (E) electoral systems with single-member, first-past-the-post districts
3. Which of the following is the best description of Great Britain's Fixed-Term Parliaments Act of 2011 ?
 - (A) It establishes a maximum three-term limit for members of the House of Commons.
 - (B) It mandates that parliamentary elections must occur every five years starting in 2015.
 - (C) It prohibits the prime minister from serving more than two consecutive terms.
 - (D) It requires that Cabinet members resign their seats as sitting members of the House of Commons.
 - (E) It stipulates that males do not precede their elder sisters in the line of succession to the British throne.
4. Which of the following is true of the legitimacy of a government?
 - (A) It has a positive correlation with the use of brute force by the government.
 - (B) It decreases when the government becomes more representative.
 - (C) It has an inverse correlation with the use of brute force by the government.
 - (D) It decreases when the government becomes less secular.
 - (E) It decreases when an ethnic minority is voted into a leadership position.
5. A nation-state is best characterized as
 - (A) a subnational unit of government such as Chiapas or Tibet
 - (B) a politically defined territory in which the state and national identity coincide
 - (C) a sovereign state where the legislature is appointed rather than elected
 - (D) the members of a regime holding power in a state
 - (E) the national majority in a democratic election
6. When David Cameron replaced Gordon Brown as prime minister, there was a change in which of the following?
 - (A) Culture
 - (B) Regime
 - (C) Nation
 - (D) State
 - (E) Government

7. Russia's constitution provides for a semipresidential system in which of the following ways?
 - (A) The president's choice for prime minister must be approved by the Duma.
 - (B) The prime minister is responsible for appointing the president.
 - (C) The prime minister is the commander in chief of the armed forces.
 - (D) The head of state is the prime minister and the president is merely a figurehead.
 - (E) The president focuses on domestic affairs and the prime minister focuses on international issues.
8. Which of the following is the best example of corporatism?
 - (A) A leader who seeks support by granting favors or rewards to certain individuals
 - (B) The liberalization of trade policy and protection of property rights
 - (C) State control of important enterprises and industries
 - (D) The sale of political offices or state assets to powerful non-state actors
 - (E) State-sanctioned business or civil organizations meant to represent the public
9. Which of the following statements concerning Mexican and Nigerian politics is most accurate?
 - (A) The bureaucracies in Nigeria and Mexico must both reflect the countries' federal characters.
 - (B) Supreme courts in both countries can exercise judicial review.
 - (C) Both the Nigerian and Mexican presidents are limited to two terms.
 - (D) Party affiliation in both Mexico and Nigeria is strongly correlated with income levels.
 - (E) Only Mexico has a bicameral legislature.
10. In Russia, the Yukos trial and the subsequent imprisonment of Mikhail Khodorkovsky reflected which of the following?
 - (A) The continued weakening of the rule of law in Russia
 - (B) The growing influence of investigative journalism in Russia
 - (C) The increased rights of citizens to sue in Russia
 - (D) The continued manipulation of the legal system by Russian businesses
 - (E) The limited rights of Chechen separatists
11. Militaries or military groups play a substantial role in government decision making in which of the following pairs of countries?
 - (A) Great Britain and Russia
 - (B) Russia and Mexico
 - (C) Iran and China
 - (D) China and Mexico
 - (E) Mexico and Great Britain
12. For most of its history, the Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) in Mexico has been
 - (A) an ethnic party
 - (B) a religious party
 - (C) a left-wing party
 - (D) a right-wing party
 - (E) a dominant party
13. Which of the following are most closely associated with authoritarian regimes?
 - (A) Regular and open elections for public offices
 - (B) Governmental transparency and open communication
 - (C) Diverse groups of political elites exercising power
 - (D) Constitutional separations of power
 - (E) Restrictions placed on civil rights and personal freedoms

14. Which of the following is a feature shared by the political systems of Great Britain and Russia?
- (A) Competitive multiparty elections
 - (B) Bicameral legislatures with two equal houses
 - (C) Supreme courts exercising judicial review
 - (D) Federalism marked by ethnicity-based regions
 - (E) Separate individuals serving as head of state and head of government
15. Which of the following has decreased as a consequence of globalization?
- (A) The interdependence of states
 - (B) Avenues of access to information
 - (C) The average citizen's ability to access information from around the world
 - (D) Barriers to trade and to the flow of capital and labor between countries
 - (E) The influence of multinational corporations on domestic policy
16. Which of the following is the most common explanation for China's economic growth after the 1980s?
- (A) China successfully attracted foreign direct investment.
 - (B) China adopted a structural readjustment program sponsored by the IMF.
 - (C) China has received extensive foreign aid.
 - (D) China adopted protectionist economic policies.
 - (E) China has experienced record highs in agricultural output.
17. Which of the following is an accurate description of why Great Britain's conflict in Northern Ireland has diminished since 1998 ?
- (A) Britain allowed Northern Ireland to become an independent state in 1998.
 - (B) Britain supported a power-sharing agreement between Protestant and Roman Catholic leaders in Northern Ireland.
 - (C) The top Irish separatist leaders were imprisoned after surrendering to the British military.
 - (D) Britain forced the government of Northern Ireland to permanently dissolve its regional government.
 - (E) Northern Ireland formally merged with the government of the Republic of Ireland.
18. Which of the following is an accurate description of a hybrid regime?
- (A) It focuses on protecting the rights of accused criminals.
 - (B) It holds regular elections for public offices.
 - (C) It ensures freedom of expression for minority groups.
 - (D) It uses independent electoral commissions to help foster transparency.
 - (E) It upholds the rule of law with the use of an independent judiciary.
19. Which of the following statements about the 2011 Nigerian presidential election is most accurate?
- (A) The leader of the People's Progressive Party won the election.
 - (B) For the first time in the Fourth Republic, a Muslim was elected.
 - (C) The election was relatively free and fair, according to most observers.
 - (D) The military intervened after the election to install its preferred candidate.
 - (E) The eventual winner did very little campaigning during the election.

20. Which of the following describes sources of political legitimacy in China and Iran?
- (A) Tribal kinship ties in China, and pastoralist agricultural traditions in Iran
 - (B) Participatory institutions in China, and technocratic governance in Iran
 - (C) Charismatic leadership in China, and military prestige in Iran
 - (D) Ideology and economic performance in China, and religious authority in Iran
 - (E) Bureaucratic efficiency in China, and political and civic freedoms in Iran
21. One similarity between Russia's Duma and China's National People's Congress is that both have
- (A) played a significant role in making policy
 - (B) extensive minority representation
 - (C) banned women from becoming representatives
 - (D) been dominated by one political party
 - (E) taken the lead on promoting environmental sustainability
22. Which of the following is an accurate statement about the status of women in China today?
- (A) Since 2002 women have won several positions on the Politburo and the Standing Committee.
 - (B) Women rarely work outside the home.
 - (C) Legal obstacles prevent women from starting private businesses.
 - (D) There are almost no women among the delegates to the National People's Congress.
 - (E) Sex-selected abortions continue even though they are illegal.
23. The institution in Iran that makes laws related to civil liberties is the
- (A) Guardian Council
 - (B) Qom Seminary
 - (C) Assembly of Experts
 - (D) Majles
 - (E) Special Clerical Court
24. Unitary systems differ from federal systems in that unitary systems
- (A) are found only in liberal democracies
 - (B) have a unicameral legislature
 - (C) guarantee no constitutional authority to subnational governments
 - (D) are typical of presidential systems
 - (E) give more power to subnational governments than to national governments
25. Which of the following policy changes occurred after Vladimir Putin came to power in Russia?
- (A) All elections for the Duma became based on proportional representation.
 - (B) State-owned industries were rapidly privatized.
 - (C) Perestroika was introduced into the economy and society.
 - (D) Glasnost allowed the media more freedom and independence.
 - (E) Shock therapy rapidly liberalized prices for goods and services.

26. Which of the following refers to a vote by the public on a particular policy issue?

- (A) Suffrage
- (B) Straw poll
- (C) Referendum
- (D) Representation
- (E) Vote of no confidence

27. Which of the following is the most accurate description of the general pattern of internal migration within Mexico?

- (A) From south to north
- (B) From east to west
- (C) From north to south
- (D) From west to north
- (E) From north to east

28. Which of the following is true of cleavages in modern Nigeria and China?

- (A) Both countries have experienced sectarian conflict among religious communities.
- (B) Both countries are experiencing deepening rural-urban divides.
- (C) Pro-western groups repeatedly clash with nationalists.
- (D) Ethnic separatism poses no major threat to central government institutions.
- (E) Social inequality has been reduced as a result of foreign investment.

FREEDOM ON THE INTERNET, 2011

Country	Limits on Content ¹ (0-35)	Violations of User Rights ² (0-40)
China	28	36
Iran	29	39
Mexico	10	10
Nigeria	10	12
Russia	17	23
Great Britain	8	16

¹ 0 = least limited content; 35 = most limited content

² 0 = least violations of user rights; 40 = most violations of user rights

Source: Freedom House

29. Based on your knowledge of comparative government and politics and the table above, which of the following statements is accurate?

- (A) Great Britain provides less freedom to Internet users than the other countries listed in the chart.
- (B) Authoritarian states monitor and restrict citizen access to the Internet.
- (C) States that have experienced terrorist attacks are more likely to violate Internet user rights than states that have not had terrorist attacks.
- (D) China and Iran use state-sponsored media to indoctrinate citizens via the Internet.
- (E) Countries that violate user rights are less likely to impose limits on content than countries that do not violate user rights.

30. The resource curse is the theory that
- (A) population growth will eventually outstrip the resources necessary to support civilization
 - (B) economies that have valuable natural resources will develop more slowly
 - (C) countries without oil cannot develop economically
 - (D) economies with fossil fuels usually have divided government
 - (E) countries with valuable natural resources will be invaded more frequently
31. Bureaucrats are best described as
- (A) legislators who are legally required to serve the public interest but in practice do not
 - (B) officials who are responsible for the implementation of public policy
 - (C) high-level elected officials in national or central governments
 - (D) powerful political actors in civil society and the private sphere
 - (E) local officials accountable to voters in the districts in which they work
32. Which of the following government types is characterized by the separation of church and state?
- (A) Corporatist
 - (B) Secular
 - (C) Theocratic
 - (D) Nationalist
 - (E) Fascist
33. Which of the following is true of the electoral systems for the legislatures in Nigeria and Mexico?
- (A) In both countries the lower house is directly elected while the upper house is not.
 - (B) Mexico uses a mix of proportional and first-past-the-post representation while Nigeria uses only first-past-the-post.
 - (C) Both have ethnic quotas for legislators.
 - (D) Mexico's electoral system includes diversity requirements while Nigeria's does not.
 - (E) Legislators in the lower houses in both countries are elected through an alternative vote system.
34. Which of the following statements best characterizes the state of civil society in Russia?
- (A) It is largely made up of internationally funded watchdog groups.
 - (B) It has attracted little interest from foreign governments and nongovernmental organizations.
 - (C) It is dominated by a large-scale movement for a return to state communism.
 - (D) It is weak in comparison with civil society in European democracies.
 - (E) It is more constrained under Putin than it was under the Soviet Union.

35. Which of the following statements is an accurate comparison of the 2009 presidential election in Iran and the 2006 presidential election in Mexico?

- (A) In both elections, the winning candidate's political party was different from the political party of his predecessor.
- (B) In both elections, voter turnout fell below 50%.
- (C) In both elections, a runoff election was held to determine the winner.
- (D) In both elections, allegations of fraud were brought by the losing party.
- (E) In both elections, the winner won with a plurality, but not a majority, of the vote.

36. The European Union (EU) and Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) are examples of

- (A) supranational organizations
- (B) nongovernmental organizations
- (C) multinational corporations
- (D) quasi-autonomous nongovernmental organizations
- (E) special economic zones

37. Which of the following policies does NOT promote globalization?

- (A) Accepting foreign direct investment in domestic firms
- (B) Becoming a member of supranational organizations
- (C) Liberalizing trade policies
- (D) Signing treaties that call for reduced tariffs
- (E) Adopting import-substitution industrialization policies

Percent of seats held by women in national parliaments, 2010 (%)	
China	21
Iran	3
Mexico	26
Nigeria	7
Russia	14
Great Britain	22

Source: World Bank, 2010

38. Based on your knowledge of comparative government and politics and the table above, which of the following statements is accurate?

- (A) Current or former communist states have more women in national parliaments than do states that have not experienced communism.
- (B) States in which a majority of the population practices a single religion have fewer women in national parliaments than do states with greater religious diversity.
- (C) There is little correlation between the level of democratization and the proportion of women serving in national parliaments.
- (D) States with proportional representation have more women in national parliaments than do states with single member districts.
- (E) Unitary states have more women in national parliaments than do federal states.

39. Which of the following development statistics is most likely indicative of an advanced economy today?
- (A) A female literacy rate of 55%
 - (B) An agricultural sector accounting for 2% of GDP
 - (C) A service sector accounting for 5% of GDP
 - (D) A high infant mortality rate
 - (E) An average life expectancy of 60 years for men
40. In which of the following sets do all states have federal governments?
- (A) Mexico, Russia, and Iran
 - (B) China, Iran, and Great Britain
 - (C) Mexico, Nigeria, and Russia
 - (D) Nigeria, Russia, and Great Britain
 - (E) China, Iran, and Mexico
41. Since 2000, which of the following political parties has held the executive branch of its respective country for the longest period?
- (A) The Green Movement of Iran
 - (B) The Communist Party of the Russian Federation
 - (C) The People's Democratic Party of Nigeria
 - (D) The Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) in Mexico
 - (E) The Conservative Party in Great Britain
42. Which of the following is an accurate description of environmental sustainability policies in China?
- (A) The Chinese government does not respond to citizen complaints about pollution.
 - (B) Chinese businesses face no environmental restrictions if they can turn a profit.
 - (C) The Chinese government has stopped certain damaging projects in response to environmental activists.
 - (D) Chinese businesses are now prohibited from using coal as an energy source.
 - (E) Chinese environmental activists often use injunctions by Chinese courts to block the expansion of business projects.
43. Unlike Mexico and Nigeria, Iran has NOT experienced which of the following?
- (A) Underdevelopment of the economy
 - (B) A recent move toward liberal democracy
 - (C) The economic benefits of finding oil
 - (D) Overpopulation, especially in rural regions
 - (E) Student uprisings protesting elections and unpopular decisions

44. National sovereignty is weakened the most by international organizations in which of the following countries?
- (A) Nigeria, because of the power of the Peace and Security Council of the African Union (AU)
 - (B) Russia, because of the power of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)-Russia Council
 - (C) Mexico, because of the power of the Secretariat of the North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA)
 - (D) Great Britain, because of the power of the Court of Justice of the European Union (EU)
 - (E) Iran, because of the power of the Secretary General of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)
45. During the 1980s, the governments of Great Britain and China did which of the following?
- (A) Promoted free markets and private profit incentives
 - (B) Heightened authoritarian rule
 - (C) Imposed stricter punishment for political dissidents
 - (D) Expanded state management of the economy
 - (E) Encouraged environmental movements
46. All of the following are policies that Russia has pursued in its relations with neighboring states since 2000 EXCEPT
- (A) greater unification with neighboring Belarus
 - (B) support of regions wanting to break away from Georgia
 - (C) increased aid for regimes that align with Russia
 - (D) increased sharing of nuclear technology with all former Soviet republics
 - (E) diplomatic pressure to force Ukraine and Belarus to pay more for natural gas
47. Which of the following challenges to the state have tended to strengthen democracy?
- (A) The growth of regional and supranational forces
 - (B) The globalization of the economy
 - (C) The growing independence of civil society
 - (D) Coups d'état led by junior army officers
 - (E) The increasing role of governmental officials with important cabinet positions
48. With regard to human rights in Iran, the Iranian government has acted in which of following ways?
- (A) The government mandates that women only have one child.
 - (B) The government targets and imprisons political opponents.
 - (C) The government protects the religious rights of Baha'is.
 - (D) The government supports gay rights and women's rights.
 - (E) The government banned executions during Ahmedinejad's presidency.
49. China's rapid industrialization over the past 30 years has done which of the following?
- (A) Narrowed the gap between the rich and the poor
 - (B) Decreased the authority of the Standing Committee of the Politburo
 - (C) Limited the flow of migrant workers to urban areas
 - (D) Produced greater environmental degradation and pollution
 - (E) Increased the types of social welfare benefits citizens receive

50. Which of the following economic changes did Vladimir Putin implement during his first two terms as president (2000–2008) ?
- (A) He implemented shock therapy.
 - (B) He gradually returned key privatized industries back to state control.
 - (C) He halted all foreign investment.
 - (D) He worked hard to improve relations with the European Union.
 - (E) He rapidly nationalized all industry in Russia.
51. Which of the following is an accurate statement about the treatment of ethnic minorities in China?
- (A) China does not permit languages to be spoken other than Mandarin.
 - (B) China protects ethnic minorities who air public grievances about unfair Chinese Communist Party policies.
 - (C) China officially protects the use of minority languages by approved minority groups.
 - (D) China does not acknowledge that any of its provinces have significant populations of ethnic minorities.
 - (E) China's policies are enforced equally throughout the country with no exceptions made for ethnic minorities.
52. Mexico and China both face challenges in policy making with respect to
- (A) the creation of special economic zones for indigenous peoples
 - (B) popular blame placed on migrants for rising violence and criminality
 - (C) the influence of the Roman Catholic Church in policy making
 - (D) regional disparities and urban-rural cleavages
 - (E) protests over regional and global free trade agreements
53. Which of the following is the best example of regime change?
- (A) The transfer of power from Gordon Brown to David Cameron
 - (B) The transfer of power from Mikhail Gorbachev to Boris Yeltsin
 - (C) The transfer of power from Umaru Musa Yar'Adua to Goodluck Jonathan
 - (D) The transfer of power from Felipe Calderón to Enrique Peña Nieto
 - (E) The transfer of power from Hu Jintao to Xi Jinping

54. Which of the following groups would most likely support Britain's Conservative Party?

- (A) Individuals who oppose the adoption of Europe's common currency
- (B) Scottish labor union members
- (C) Individuals who support a stronger National Health Service
- (D) Immigrant workers living in urban areas
- (E) Individuals in Northern Ireland who support the separatist movement

55. Which of the following is a common criticism of first-past-the-post voting systems?

- (A) Electoral mandates are difficult to achieve.
- (B) They are strongly correlated with negative economic growth.
- (C) Officials cannot be held electorally accountable.
- (D) Minority groups may be underrepresented.
- (E) Social and ethnic tensions tend to become inflamed.

END OF SECTION I.

**IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, YOU MAY
CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS SECTION.**

DO NOT GO ON TO SECTION II UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE DONE THE FOLLOWING.

- **PLACED YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **WRITTEN AND GRIDDED YOUR AP NUMBER CORRECTLY ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **TAKEN THE AP EXAM LABEL FROM THE FRONT OF THIS BOOKLET AND PLACED IT ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**

**2015 AP[®] COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS
FREE-RESPONSE QUESTIONS**

COMPARATIVE GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Section II

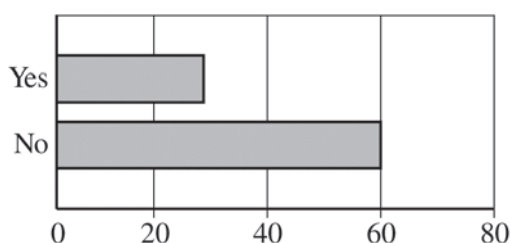
Time—1 hour and 40 minutes

Directions: You have 100 minutes to answer five short-answer concept questions, one conceptual analysis question, and two country context questions. Unless the directions indicate otherwise, respond to all parts of all eight questions. It is suggested that you take a few minutes to plan and outline each answer. We suggest that you spend approximately 30 minutes total on questions 1 through 5, 30 minutes on question 6, and 40 minutes total on questions 7 and 8. These suggested times do not reflect the weight of the questions as part of your AP exam score. In your responses, use substantive examples where appropriate.

Short-Answer Concepts: We suggest that you spend approximately 30 minutes total on questions 1 through 5.

1. Identify one ethnic minority group officially recognized by the Chinese government. Describe one special protection that the Chinese government extends to the group you identified. Explain why the Chinese government extends special protections to some of China's ethnic minority groups.
2. Describe why governments adopt austerity measures. Identify one austerity measure adopted by the British government since 2007. Explain one political consequence of that measure.
3. Identify one way members of the Guardian Council are selected. Describe two specific functions of the Guardian Council.
4. Explain how independent judiciaries strengthen democracy. Describe two actions that an authoritarian regime can take to undermine the independence of the judiciary.

PERCENTAGE OF RESPONDENTS WHO
WERE ASKED IF THEY WERE SATISFIED WITH
THE POLITICAL SITUATION IN RUSSIA



Source: Pew Research Global Attitudes Project, 2011

5. Write an empirical statement using the data from the graph above. Write a normative statement using the data from the graph above. Identify which type of statement a political scientist would use to make a factual argument: empirical or normative.

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FREE-RESPONSE QUESTIONS

Conceptual Analysis: We suggest that you spend approximately 30 minutes on question 6.

6. State sovereignty can be challenged by external factors.
- (a) Define sovereignty.
 - (b) Identify one international organization that challenges state sovereignty AND describe how it challenges state sovereignty.
 - (c) Describe a challenge that multinational corporations pose to state sovereignty.
 - (d) Describe a challenge that new information technologies pose to state sovereignty.
 - (e) Describe one method states use to maintain sovereignty in the face of challenges.

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FREE-RESPONSE QUESTIONS

Country Context: We suggest that you spend approximately 40 minutes (20 minutes each) on questions 7 and 8.

7. Party systems in Mexico and Russia affect the political legitimacy of each state.
- (a) Identify Mexico's historically dominant party, and identify the type of party system Mexico currently has.
 - (b) Describe two reforms since 1980 that facilitated Mexico's transition away from a dominant party system.
 - (c) Identify Russia's current dominant party.
 - (d) Describe two reforms since 2000 that allowed Russia to establish a dominant party system.
 - (e) Explain how a dominant party system can promote political legitimacy. Explain how a dominant party system can hinder political legitimacy.

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FREE-RESPONSE QUESTIONS

8. The governments of both Great Britain and Nigeria have responded to domestic terrorism in the last twenty years.
- (a) Identify one group that has engaged in terrorism in Great Britain and describe its major demand.
 - (b) Describe one policy response the government of Great Britain adopted to address domestic terrorism.
 - (c) Identify one group that has engaged in terrorism in Nigeria and describe its major demand.
 - (d) Describe one policy response the government of Nigeria adopted to address domestic terrorism.

STOP

END OF EXAM

Answer Key
2015 AP Comparative Government and Politics
Section I

Question 1: E	Question 29: B
Question 2: C	Question 30: B
Question 3: B	Question 31: B
Question 4: C	Question 32: B
Question 5: B	Question 33: B
Question 6: E	Question 34: D
Question 7: A	Question 35: D
Question 8: E	Question 36: A
Question 9: B	Question 37: E
Question 10: A	Question 38: C
Question 11: C	Question 39: B
Question 12: E	Question 40: C
Question 13: E	Question 41: C
Question 14: E	Question 42: C
Question 15: D	Question 43: B
Question 16: A	Question 44: D
Question 17: B	Question 45: A
Question 18: B	Question 46: D
Question 19: C	Question 47: C
Question 20: D	Question 48: B
Question 21: D	Question 49: D
Question 22: E	Question 50: B
Question 23: D	Question 51: C
Question 24: C	Question 52: D
Question 25: A	Question 53: B
Question 26: C	Question 54: A
Question 27: A	Question 55: D
Question 28: B	

Question Descriptors and Performance Data

2016 AP Comparative Government and Politics

This table shows the content assessed, the correct answer, and how AP students performed on each question.

Multiple-Choice Questions

Questions	Topic	Sub-Topic	Answer	% Correct
1	Political Institutions	Electoral systems	E	78
2	Political Institutions	Elections	C	65
3	Political Institutions	Legislature	B	43
4	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Legitimacy	C	80
5	Intro to Comparative	Classifying govt & pol	B	81
6	Political & Economic Change	Political change	E	66
7	Political Institutions	Executive	A	64
8	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Regime types	E	39
9	Political Institutions	Judiciary	B	31
10	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Sources of power	A	40
11	Political Institutions	Military & other coercive institutions	C	58
12	Political Institutions	Political parties	E	84
13	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Regime types	E	94
14	Political Institutions	Executive	E	74
15	Political & Economic Change	Globalization & fragmentation	D	75
16	Political & Economic Change	Relationship between political & economic change	A	67
17	Public Policy	Factors in public policymaking & implementation	B	55
18	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Governance & accountability	B	37
19	Political Institutions	Elections	C	59
20	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Legitimacy	D	88
21	Political Institutions	Legislature	D	74
22	Public Policy	Common policy issues	E	35
23	Political Institutions	Institutional relations	D	65
24	Intro to Comparative	Concepts	C	75
25	Public Policy	Factors in public policymaking & implementation	A	56
26	Intro to Comparative	Concepts	C	83
27	Citizens Society & the State	Cleavages & politics	A	88
28	Citizens Society & the State	Cleavages & politics	B	65
29	Citizens Society & the State	Media roles	B	76
30	Political & Economic Change	Relationship between political & economic change	B	31
31	Political Institutions	Bureaucracies	B	66

Questions	Topic	Sub-Topic	Answer	% Correct
32	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Regime types	B	82
33	Political Institutions	Electoral systems	B	63
34	Citizens Society & the State	Civil society	D	76
35	Political Institutions	Elections	D	50
36	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Supranational governance	A	86
37	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Supranational governance	E	80
38	Citizens Society & the State	Citizenship / social representation	C	48
39	Political & Economic Change	Economic change	B	60
40	Political Institutions	Forms of government	C	73
41	Political Institutions	Political parties	C	31
42	Public Policy	Common policy issues	C	47
43	Political & Economic Change	Political change	B	65
44	Sovereignty Authority & Power	Supranational governance	D	51
45	Political & Economic Change	Economic change	A	73
46	Sovereignty Authority & Power	State building & stability	D	53
47	Citizens Society & the State	Civil society	C	66
48	Citizens Society & the State	Citizenship / social representation	B	61
49	Public Policy	Factors in public policymaking & implementation	D	88
50	Public Policy	Factors in public policymaking & implementation	B	57
51	Citizens Society & the State	Cleavages & politics	C	31
52	Public Policy	Factors in public policymaking & implementation	D	84
53	Political & Economic Change	Political change	B	51
54	Political Institutions	Political parties	A	73
55	Political Institutions	Electoral systems	D	83

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Question 1

3 points

One point is earned for correctly identifying one minority ethnic group officially recognized by the Chinese government. Acceptable identifications may include:

- Uighurs
- Tibetans
- Zhuang
- Manchu
- Mongol
- Hui

One point is earned for a correct description of a special protection that the Chinese government extends to this group.

Note: The description of the special protection must be linked to the group identified.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Language rights
- Exceptions to population control policies
- Educational curriculum
- Legislative seats reserved
- Autonomous regions
- Religion (can be seen as a cultural right if it is tied to the correct group)

One point is earned for a correct explanation of why the Chinese government extends special protections to some minority ethnic groups.

Acceptable explanations include:

- Reduce conflict or rebellion or unrest
- Prevent groups from seeking separation
- Increase legitimacy
- Increase access to natural resources
- Make policy comply with party doctrine
- Improve global image
- Create buffer from other states

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 2

3 points

One point is earned for a correct description of why governments adopt austerity measures.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- To fix budget deficit problems
- Pressure by international organizations
- Membership in supranational organizations that require monetary coordination
- Changes in government or party platform

Note: Stating that “the economy is bad” is not enough to earn credit.

One point is earned for a correct identification of an austerity measure adopted by the British government since 2007.

Acceptable identifications include:

- Raising taxes
- Cutting spending to welfare or social programs
- Raised fees for universities
- Reduced funding for QUANGOs

One point is earned for a correct explanation of a political consequence of that measure.

Acceptable explanations include:

- Loss of support for the Conservatives
- Greater support for the Conservatives
- Greater support for anti-austerity Scottish National Party (SNP) and UK Independence Party (UKIP)
- A revolt within the ranks of the Liberal Democrats and the Labour Party
- Liberal Democrats voted out of office
- Social movement activities such as protests and demonstrations

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 3

3 points

One point is earned for a correct identification of a way members of the Guardian Council are selected.

Acceptable identifications include:

- The supreme leader chooses one-half of Guardian Council members.
- The head of the judiciary nominates one-half of Guardian Council members.
- The Majles approves the nominees made by the judiciary.

One point is earned for EACH correct description of a specific function of the Guardian Council.

Acceptable descriptions may include:

- Vetting candidates for elections
- Monitoring elections
- Overseeing the Majles
- Approving legislation passed by the Majles
- Vetoing legislation passed by the Majles
- Making sure laws or government actions are compatible with Islamic law
- Making sure laws are compatible with the Constitution
- Advising the supreme leader on matters related to jurist guardianship

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 4

3 points

One point is earned for a correct explanation of how independent judiciaries strengthen democracy.

Acceptable explanations include:

- Maintain checks and balances
- Protect rights and liberties
- Establish rule of law
- Maintain separation of powers
- Hold government accountable
- Provide access point to the legal system for citizens
- Ensure free, fair, and contested elections

One point is earned for EACH correct description of an action that an authoritarian regime can take to undermine the independence of the judiciary.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Appointing loyal judges
- Removing or threatening removal of judges
- Promising rewards for loyalty or bribes
- Blackmailing or intimidating judges
- Refusing to implement or ignoring judicial decisions
- Limiting the court's powers or jurisdiction
- Allowing direct intervention by executive or police
- Controlling legal education or professional associations
- Ruling by decree or referendum

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 5

3 points

One point is earned for a correct empirical statement using data from the graph.

An acceptable statement may include:

- Sixty percent of Russians are not satisfied with the way things are going.
- Thirty percent of Russians are satisfied with the way things are going.
- More Russians are dissatisfied with the way things are going than are satisfied.

One point is earned for a correct normative statement using data from the graph.

An acceptable statement may include:

- Russia should change to a parliamentary system to satisfy the 60 percent of the population who are unhappy with the way things are going.
- Russians need to have a revolution because they are dissatisfied.
- Russia shouldn't change anything because 30 percent of the people are satisfied.
- Russia ought to become a democracy to address citizens' discontent.
- Based on the data, Russia's political system is terrible.

Note: The empirical and normative statements above are not exhaustive. The response must use data from the graph to earn credit.

One point is earned for correctly identifying an **empirical** statement as the type of statement that a political scientist would use to make a factual argument.

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 6

6 points

Part (a): 1 point

One point is earned for a correct definition of sovereignty.

An acceptable definition will include at least TWO of the following:

- Supreme or independent authority
- Authority over a particular population or territory
- Recognition by other international actors

Part (b): 2 points

One point is earned for a correct identification of an international organization that challenges state sovereignty.

Acceptable identifications include:

- United Nations
- European Union
- North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)
- Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)
- Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)
- Terrorist groups that meet certain conditions

Note: NAFTA is not an international organization.

One point is earned for a correct description of how the international organization challenges state sovereignty.

An acceptable response will demonstrate that the international organization attempts to or succeeds in exerting control or authority in sovereign states.

Part (c): 1 point

One point is earned for a correct description of how multinational corporations (MNCs) challenge state sovereignty.

An acceptable response will demonstrate that MNCs attempt to, or successfully, exert leverage or control.

Examples may include challenges to any of the following policies:

- Labor
- Environmental
- Land rights
- Tax
- Budgetary
- Legal

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Question 6 (continued)

Part (d): 1 point

One point is earned for a correct description of how new information technologies challenge state sovereignty.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Provide access to information, reducing public support
- Provide access to information, challenging political legitimacy
- Increase government internal or external accountability
- Threat to national security or the capacity to govern from cybersecurity incidents

Part (e): 1 point

One point is earned for a correct description of a method states use to maintain sovereignty in the face of challenges.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Control information
- Leave the international organization
- Restrict multinational corporations
- Nationalize industry
- Join the international organization to influence policy direction
- Ignore or defy international organizations

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 7

8 points

Part (a): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly identifying the PRI as Mexico's historically dominant party AND for identifying Mexico's current party system as multiparty.

Part (b): 2 points

One point is earned for EACH correct description of a reform that facilitated Mexico's transition away from a dominant party system.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- The establishment of the IFE
- More autonomy and strength for the IFE
- The elimination of el dedazo
- A series of electoral reforms to encourage minority representation
- Privatizing state-owned corporations, decreasing patronage
- Decentralization reform, reducing PRI power at the subnational level
- Zedillo's decision to use primaries for the PRI

Part (c): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly identifying United Russia as Russia's current dominant party.

Note: A response merely stating "Putin's party" does not earn a point.

Part (d): 2 points

One point is earned for EACH correct description of a reform that allowed Russia to establish a dominant party system.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Increasing the threshold
- Instituting election rule changes that encourage dominant party selection by candidates
- Eliminating gubernatorial elections or appointment of governors
- Creating unequal access to media
- Raising registration requirements for parties
- Allowing only legally registered parties to run for office
- Using selective court decisions to disqualify candidates

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Question 7 (continued)

Part (e): 2 points

One point is earned for a correct explanation of how a dominant party can promote political legitimacy.

Acceptable explanations include:

- Promotes stability
- Brings about policy continuity
- Creates more efficient policymaking, reduces gridlock
- Gains a majority of votes in an election
- Boosts nationalism
- Creates a better investment environment
- Enacts necessary reforms

One point is earned for a correct explanation of how a dominant party can hinder political legitimacy.

Acceptable explanations include:

- Limits competitiveness or voter choice
- Increases chances for authoritarianism
- Undermines checks and balances
- Reduces representativeness or popular voice
- Undermines the opposition
- Encourages corruption

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.

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Question 8

6 points

Part (a): 2 points

One point is earned for correctly identifying one group that has engaged in terrorism in Great Britain.

One point is earned for correctly describing the group's major demand.

Group that has engaged in terrorism in Great Britain in the last 20 years	The group's major demand
• IRA (Irish Republican Army) • Northern Irish extremist groups	• Withdrawal of British troops from Northern Ireland • Unify with Republic of Ireland • Increased autonomy for Northern Ireland from Great Britain
• Al Qaeda • Islamic extremists	• Withdrawal of British troops from Iraq/Afghanistan • Ending British support for Israel • Ending Western influence in Muslim world

Part (b): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly describing a policy response the government of Great Britain adopted to address domestic terrorism:

- Funding for antiterrorism policing and alert systems
- Stricter laws about immigration
- CCTV surveillance
- Limitations of civil liberties
- Public education campaigns
- Dialogue with religious communities
- Withdrawal of troops from contested areas

For Northern Ireland only:

- Peace treaty (Good Friday Peace Accord)
- Devolution to a Northern Ireland Parliament (Stormont)
- Power-sharing agreement

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Question 8 (continued)

Part (c): 2 points

One point is earned for correctly identifying one group that has engaged in terrorism in Nigeria.

One point is earned for correctly describing the group's major demand.

Group that has engaged in terrorism in Nigeria in the last 20 years	The group's major demand
• Boko Haram • ISIS (ISIL/Islamic State/Daesh) • Al Qaeda • Islamic extremists	• Islamic State • Rejection of Western influence • Rejection of modernization • Rejection of female empowerment
• MEND • MOSOP • Niger Delta extremists	• Environmental justice • Economic justice/equitable access to oil revenues

Part (d): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly describing a policy response the government of Nigeria adopted to address domestic terrorism:

- Deployed the military
- Requested international support
- Negotiated amnesties
- Initiated payments to disrupted communities
- High-level arrests

A score of zero (0) is earned for an attempted answer that earns no points or an off-task answer.

A score of dash (—) is earned for a blank.